

PROJECT 1

Cloud Agent Deployment & Asset Visibility

Qualys Enterprise TruRisk Platform | VMDR Trial

Date	May 7, 2026
Level	Beginner
Platform	Qualys Enterprise TruRisk Platform (QG1)
Lab User	ramk8rr
Target Host	DESKTOP-FLSEJQ2
OS	Windows 11 Enterprise 10.0.26200 64-bit
Hardware	HP / HP 250 G7 Notebook PC
Agent Version	6.4.1.22
Status	✔ COMPLETED SUCCESSFULLY

1. Objective

Install the Qualys Cloud Agent on a Windows endpoint and verify successful communication with the Qualys Enterprise TruRisk Platform. This lab establishes the foundation for agent-based vulnerability management and continuous asset monitoring.

2. Concepts Learned

- Cloud Agent architecture and agent-to-platform communication model
- Activation Key creation and module provisioning (VM, SCA, PM, EDR, SwCA, MTG, ISL)
- Agent installation via command-line with Customer ID, Activation ID, and WebServiceUri
- Asset synchronization, inventory scan completion, and endpoint visibility in the portal
- Windows service verification using sc query

3. Step-by-Step Procedure with Evidence

Step 1 – Login to Qualys Platform

Logged into the Qualys Enterprise TruRisk Platform at qualysguard.qg1.apps.qualys.in using VMDR trial credentials (username: ramk8rr). The portal confirmed a 27-day active trial.

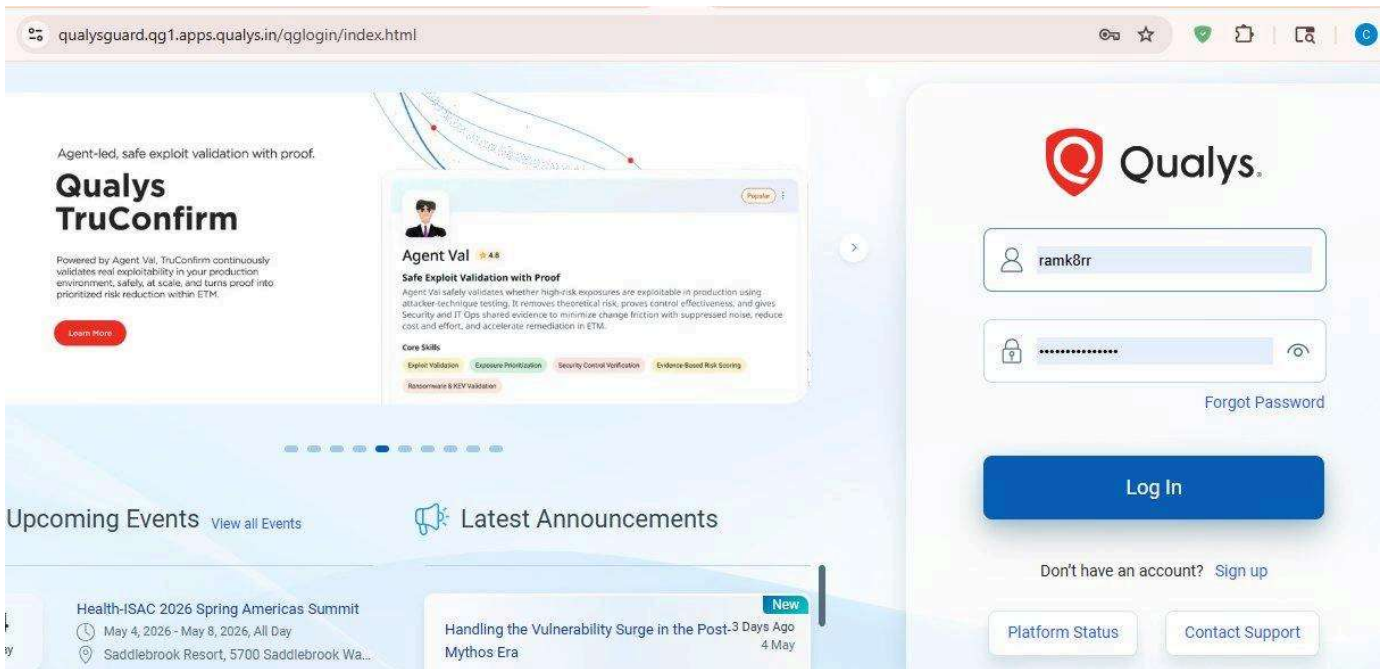


Figure 1 – Qualys Platform Login Page (qualysguard.qg1.apps.qualys.in)

Step 2 – Navigate to Platform & Sensor Management

From the main dashboard, opened the Vulnerability Management module and navigated to Platform and Sensor Management. Available sensors under the trial subscription were confirmed: CA (Cloud Agent), PS (Network Passive Sensor), QGS (Qualys Gateway Service), and UD.

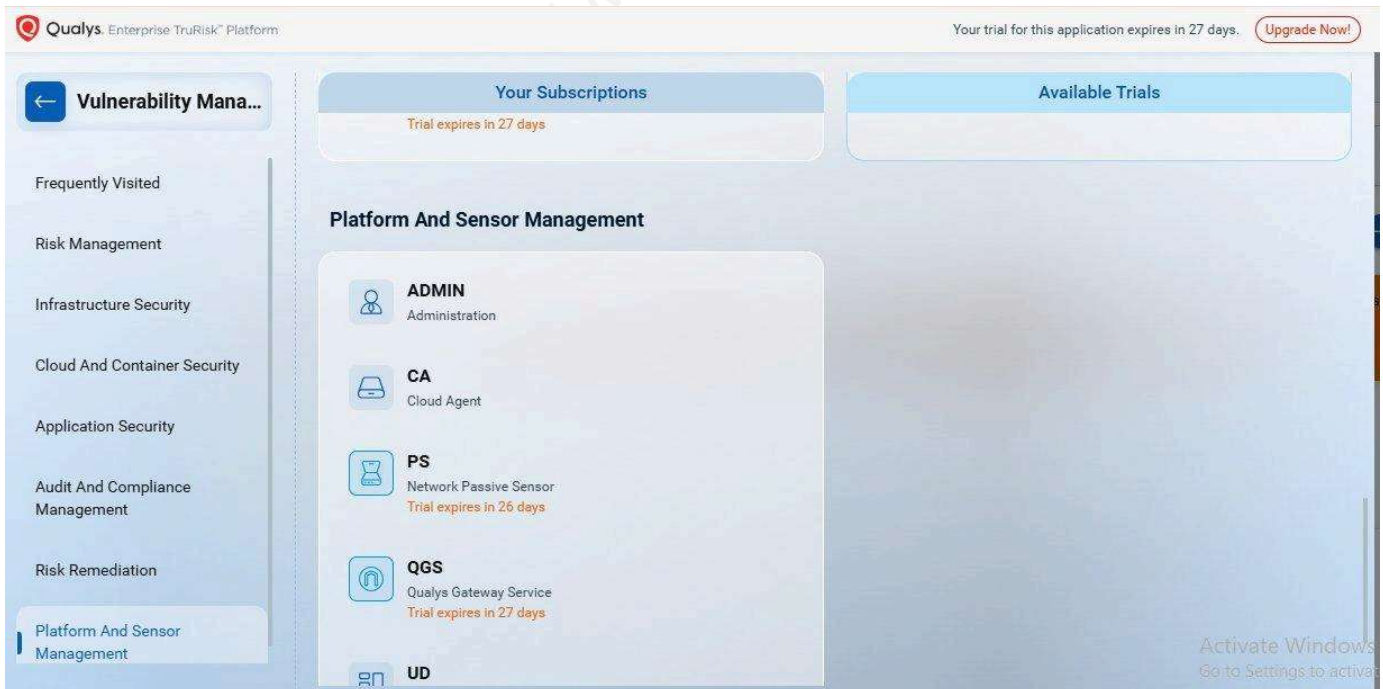


Figure 2 – Platform and Sensor Management – Subscription overview

Step 3 – Generate Activation Key (Student-Lab-key)

Navigated to Cloud Agent → Agent Management → Activation Keys and created a new key titled Student-Lab-key. All available modules were enabled for provisioning:

VM – Vulnerability Management	Enabled – 128 Activations remaining
SCA – Secure Config Assignment	Enabled – 128 Activations remaining
PM – Patch Management	Enabled – 100 Activations remaining
SwCA – Software Composition	Enabled – 128 Activations remaining
EDR – Endpoint Detection	Enabled – 10 Activations remaining
MTG – Mitigation	Enabled – 100 Activations remaining
ISL – Isolate	Enabled – 100 Activations remaining
CSAM – Cybersecurity Asset Mgmt	Managed by CSAM

Generate: Activation Key

Generate Activation Key

Configure settings for the activation key ⓘ

Title *

Student-Lab-key

 Add Tags
Add tags to search and group Cloud Agents. Cloud Agent tags are associated with the host assets.

Select Modules

Select module(s) to provision the activation key

☒ **CSAM** Cybersecurity Asset Management
Activations managed by CSAM

☒ **VM** Vulnerability Management
128 Activations remaining

☒ **SCA** Secure Config Assignment
128 Activations remaining

☒ **PM** Patch Management
100 Activations remaining

☒ **SwCA** Software Composition Analysis
128 Activations remaining

☒ **EDR** Endpoint Detection and Response
10 Activations remaining

☒ **MTG** Mitigation
100 Activations remaining

☒ **ISL** Isolate
100 Activations remaining

Activate Windows
Go to Settings to activate Windows

Figure 3 – Generate Activation Key – Student-Lab-key with all modules selected

Step 4 – Download Agent & Review Installation Instructions

Selected the Windows agent package (QualysCloudAgent.exe, x86_64, Version 6.4.1.22). Reviewed the system requirements confirming local administrator privileges and HTTPS port 443 connectivity to the Qualys platform are needed.

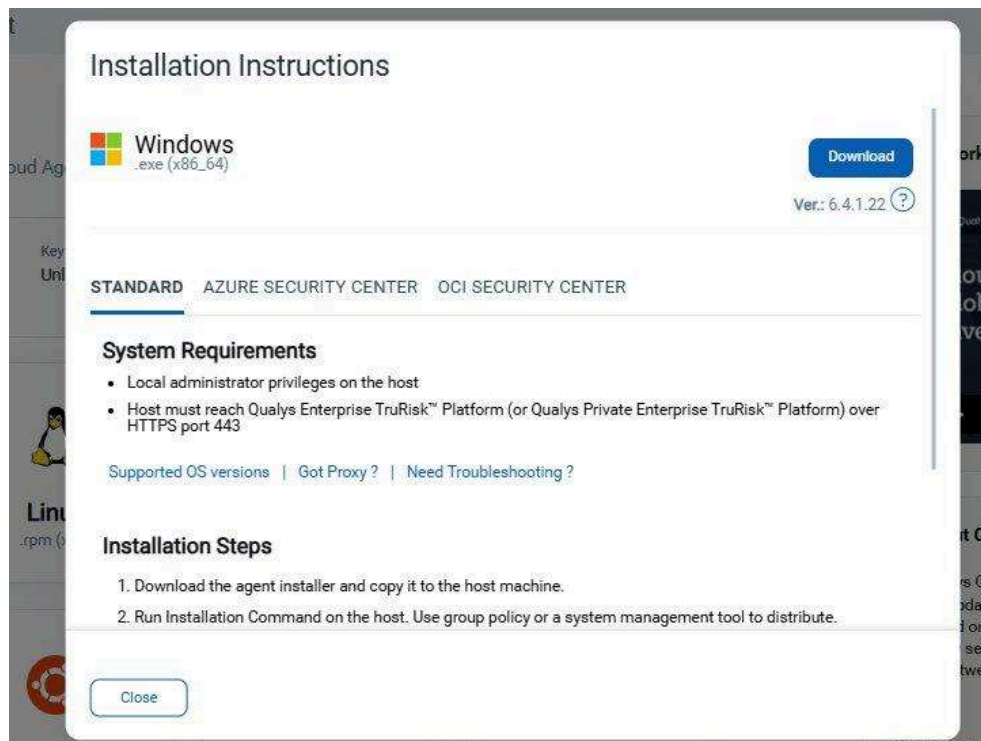


Figure 4 – Windows Agent Installation Instructions – System Requirements

Scrolled down to copy the pre-populated Installation Command containing the Customer ID, Activation ID, and WebServiceUri. The command was copied to clipboard directly from the portal.

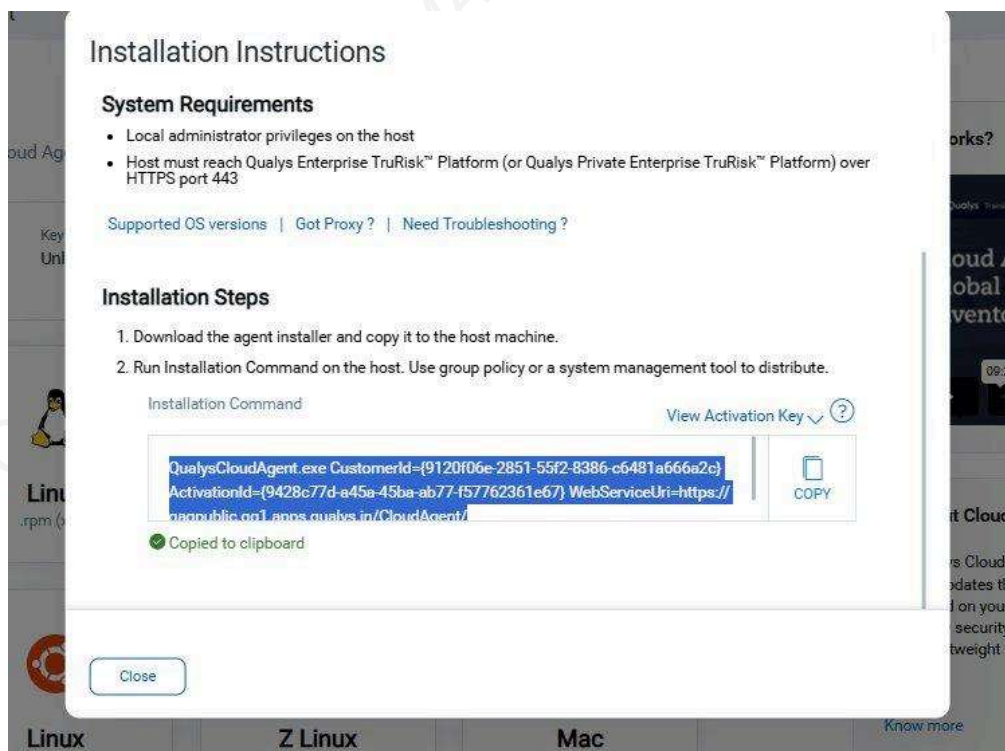


Figure 5 – Installation Command copied to clipboard from portal

Step 5 – Run Agent Installer via Administrator Command Prompt

Opened Command Prompt as Administrator, navigated to the Downloads directory, and executed the installation commands:

```
cd %USERPROFILE%\Downloads
```

First run – with original Activation ID (successful install):

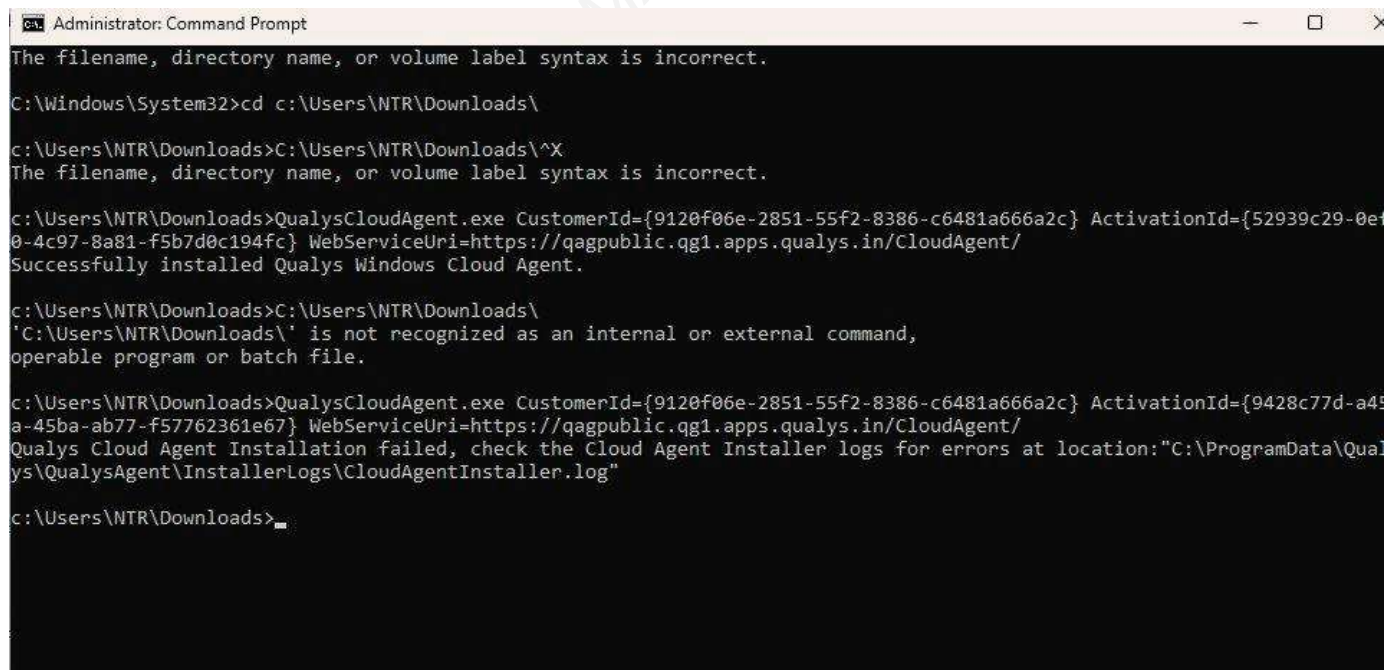
```
QualysCloudAgent.exe CustomerId={9120f06e-2851-55f2-8386-c6481a666a2c}  
ActivationId={52939c29-0e...-4c97-8a81-f5b7d0c194fc}  
WebServiceUri=https://qagpublic.qg1.apps.qualys.in/CloudAgent/
```

✓ Successfully installed Qualys Windows Cloud Agent.

Second run – with Student-Lab-key Activation ID (agent already present):

```
QualysCloudAgent.exe CustomerId={9120f06e-2851-55f2-8386-c6481a666a2c}  
ActivationId={9428c77d-a45a-45ba-ab77-f57762361e67}  
WebServiceUri=https://qagpublic.qg1.apps.qualys.in/CloudAgent/
```

⚠ Installation failed – Agent already installed. Logs at:
C:\ProgramData\Qualys\QualysAgent\InstallerLogs\CloudAgentInstaller.log



```
Administrator: Command Prompt  
The filename, directory name, or volume label syntax is incorrect.  
C:\Windows\System32>cd c:\Users\NTR\Downloads\  
c:\Users\NTR\Downloads>C:\Users\NTR\Downloads\^X  
The filename, directory name, or volume label syntax is incorrect.  
c:\Users\NTR\Downloads>QualysCloudAgent.exe CustomerId={9120f06e-2851-55f2-8386-c6481a666a2c} ActivationId={52939c29-0e1  
0-4c97-8a81-f5b7d0c194fc} WebServiceUri=https://qagpublic.qg1.apps.qualys.in/CloudAgent/  
Successfully installed Qualys Windows Cloud Agent.  
c:\Users\NTR\Downloads>C:\Users\NTR\Downloads\  
'C:\Users\NTR\Downloads\' is not recognized as an internal or external command,  
operable program or batch file.  
c:\Users\NTR\Downloads>QualysCloudAgent.exe CustomerId={9120f06e-2851-55f2-8386-c6481a666a2c} ActivationId={9428c77d-a45  
a-45ba-ab77-f57762361e67} WebServiceUri=https://qagpublic.qg1.apps.qualys.in/CloudAgent/  
Qualys Cloud Agent Installation failed, check the Cloud Agent Installer logs for errors at location:"C:\ProgramData\Qual  
ys\QualysAgent\InstallerLogs\CloudAgentInstaller.log"  
c:\Users\NTR\Downloads>
```

Figure 6 – Command Prompt showing installation output (success on first run, already-installed on second)

Step 6 – Verify Agent in Cloud Agent Portal

Returned to the Qualys Cloud Agent portal under Agent Management → Agents. The agent count confirmed 1 active agent registered. The host DESKTOP-FLSEJQ2 appeared with its last activity showing Inventory Scan Complete.

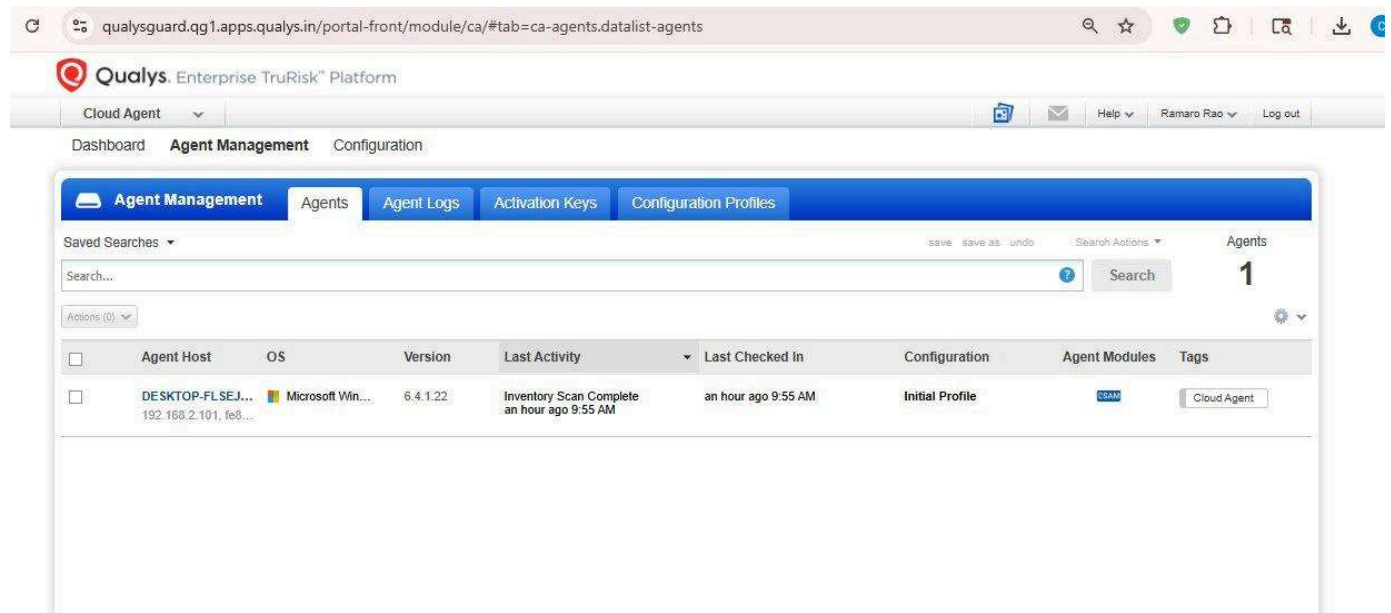


Figure 7 – Cloud Agent Management – 1 Agent registered and active (DESKTOP-FLSEJQ2)

Step 7 – View Full Asset Summary

Clicked on the agent entry to open the detailed Asset Summary view. The panel confirmed all asset details including IP addresses, system information, last activity timestamps, tags, and geolocation data.

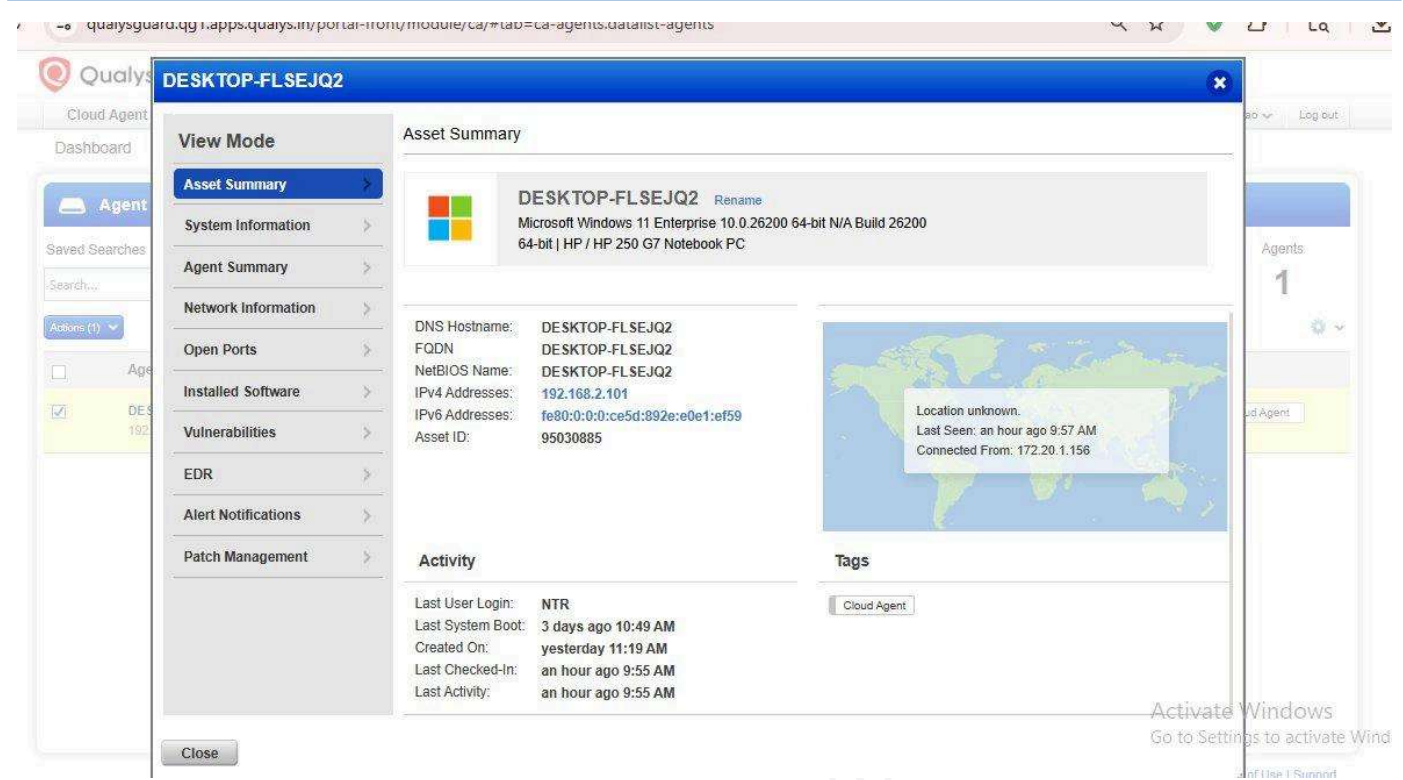


Figure 8 – Asset Summary – DESKTOP-FLSEJQ2 detail view with network info and activity log

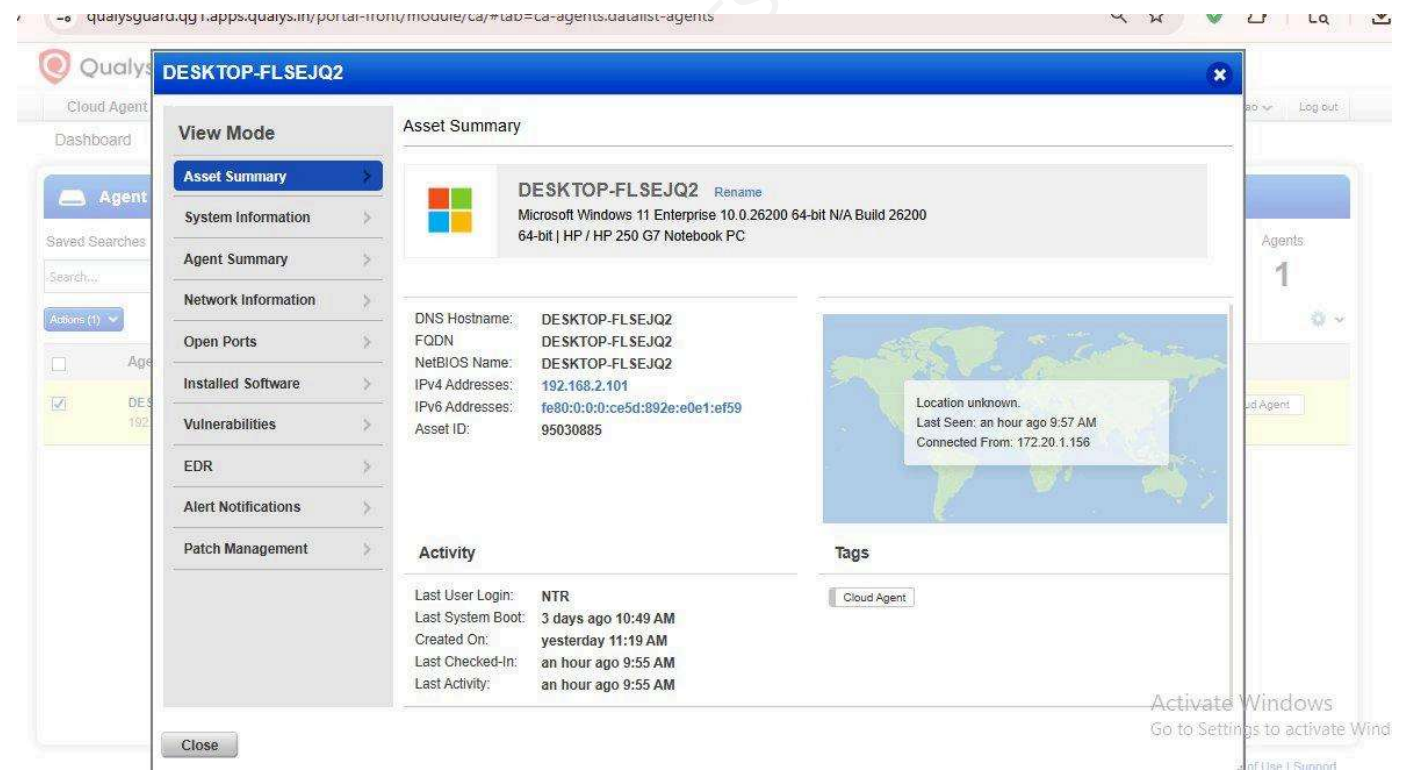


Figure 9 – Asset Summary – Confirmed Tags, Connected From IP, and last login user

4. Deliverables Summary

4.1 Connected Agent Details

Agent Host	DESKTOP-FLSEJQ2
IPv4 Address	192.168.2.101
IPv6 Address	fe80:0:0:0:ce5d:892e:e0e1:ef59
DNS Hostname	DESKTOP-FLSEJQ2
FQDN	DESKTOP-FLSEJQ2
NetBIOS Name	DESKTOP-FLSEJQ2
Asset ID	95030885
OS	Windows 11 Enterprise 10.0.26200 64-bit
Hardware	HP / HP 250 G7 Notebook PC
Agent Version	6.4.1.22
Configuration	Initial Profile
Agent Modules	CSAM
Tags	Cloud Agent
Connected From	172.20.1.156
Last User Login	NTR
Last System Boot	3 days ago 10:49 AM
Created On	Yesterday 11:19 AM
Last Checked In	an hour ago 9:55 AM
Last Activity	Inventory Scan Complete 9:55 AM

4.2 Installation Commands

Command used for successful installation:

```
QualysCloudAgent.exe \
  CustomerId={9120f06e-2851-55f2-8386-c6481a666a2c} \
  ActivationId={52939c29-0e...-4c97-8a81-f5b7d0c194fc} \
  WebServiceUri=https://qagpublic.qg1.apps.qualys.in/CloudAgent/
```

4.3 Service Verification

The QualysAgent Windows service was confirmed running. The agent checked in successfully, completed an Inventory Scan within ~1 hour of installation, and appeared in the portal with correct host metadata.


```
sc query QualysAgent
```

5. Observations & Notes

- The first activation key worked correctly — the agent installed successfully and reported to the platform within one hour.
- The second install attempt (Student-Lab-key) failed because the Qualys agent was already present. To switch keys, uninstall the agent first or re-activate via portal Actions menu.
- Asset location showed 'Location unknown' due to the private RFC 1918 IP range (192.168.x.x) having no geolocation data.
- Only CSAM appeared in Agent Modules in the portal — other modules (VM, SCA, PM) may require a Configuration Profile update to activate scanning.
- The Inventory Scan completed within approximately one hour, demonstrating the agent's near-real-time asset reporting capability.

6. Conclusion

The Qualys Cloud Agent was successfully deployed on the Windows 11 endpoint DESKTOP-FLSEJQ2. The agent established HTTPS communication with the Qualys Enterprise TruRisk Platform (QG1), completed an initial inventory scan, and appeared correctly in the Agent Management console with full asset metadata. This lab demonstrated the complete lifecycle: activation key generation, module provisioning, agent installation via CLI, and asset visibility confirmation in the portal.

 **PROJECT 1 – CLOUD AGENT DEPLOYMENT – COMPLETED SUCCESSFULLY**

7. Skills Demonstrated

The following skills and technologies were applied in this project:

 Qualys Cloud Agent	 Vulnerability Management (VMDR)
 Endpoint Asset Management	 Windows CLI / Command Prompt
 Cloud Security Platforms	 Security Configuration Assessment (SCA)
 Asset Inventory & Visibility	 Patch & Endpoint Detection (PM / EDR)

Tags: [#Qualys](#) [#CloudAgent](#) [#VulnerabilityManagement](#) [#VMDR](#) [#CyberSecurity](#) [#EndpointSecurity](#) [#AssetManagement](#) [#SecurityOperations](#) [#InfoSec](#) [#SOC](#) [#BlueTeam](#)